

US-Iran War 2026 — Stock Market Crisis Analysis

A real-world Excel financial analysis project examining how the US-Iran War (March 2026) crashed global stock markets — identifying winners, losers, and key investment lessons.

Project Overview

When war broke out between the US and Iran on March 3, 2026, global markets were thrown into chaos. The S&P 500 wiped all its yearly gains in a single month. Oil hit \$120 per barrel. Tech stocks crashed while Defence and Energy stocks surged.

This project analyses **5 major US stocks** across **4 contrasting sectors** to understand exactly what happened — and why.

The Crisis — Key Events

Date	Event
March 3, 2026	Israel strikes Iran nuclear sites — war begins
March 3, 2026	Dow Jones tumbles 1,200 points at market open
March 9, 2026	Brent crude oil hits \$120/barrel — highest since 2022
March 9, 2026	S&P 500 wipes ALL 2026 gains in single session
March 12, 2026	SPY ETF down 7.9%, QQQ down 8.2% for the month
March 24, 2026	Iran charges \$2M per ship through Strait of Hormuz
March 31, 2026	Iran signals peace talks — markets surge 3% relief rally
April 2026	Ceasefire announced — partial recovery begins

Stocks Analysed

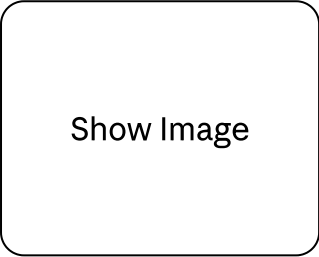
Ticker	Company	Sector	Why Chosen
AAPL	Apple Inc.	Technology	Crisis LOSER — tech sells off
MSFT	Microsoft Corp.	Technology	Crisis LOSER — inflation fears

Ticker	Company	Sector	Why Chosen
XOM	ExxonMobil	Energy	Crisis WINNER — oil price surge
LMT	Lockheed Martin	Defence	Crisis WINNER — war contracts
JPM	JPMorgan Chase	Finance	MIXED — rate uncertainty

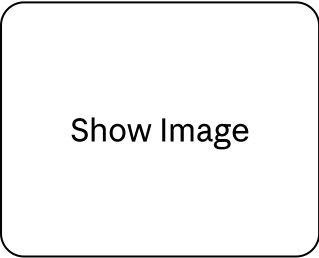


Dashboard Preview

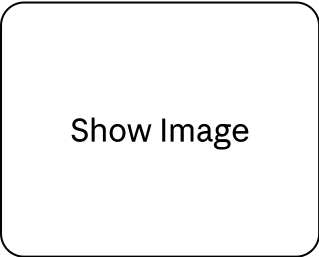
5_DASHBOARD — Main Crisis Dashboard



4_My_Analysis — Formula Analysis Sheet



3_Sector_Impact — Sector by Sector Breakdown





Key Results

Stock	Jan Price	Mar (Crash)	Apr Price	Return	Verdict
AAPL	\$243.00	\$218.00 	\$225.00	-7.4%	Lost during crisis
MSFT	\$442.00	\$395.00 	\$410.00	-7.2%	Lost during crisis
XOM	\$108.50	\$128.00 	\$131.00	+20.7%	Oil boom winner

Stock	Jan Price	Mar (Crash)	Apr Price	Return	Verdict
LMT	\$527.00	\$624.00 	\$648.00	+22.9%	War contract winner
JPM	\$239.50	\$228.00 	\$233.00	-2.7%	Mixed — rate fears

⚡ Sector Impact Summary

Sector	Price Change	Impact	Why
Technology	-8% to -13%	 Hard Hit	AI spending fears + inflation pressure
Energy	+15% to +20%	 Big Winner	Oil price surge to \$120/barrel
Defence	+25% to +30%	 Big Winner	\$4.76B Pentagon contract awarded
Airlines	-3% to -5%	 Hard Hit	Jet fuel costs surge
Semiconductors	-6% to -9%	 Hard Hit	Supply chain fears + risk-off
Finance	-5% to -8%	 Mixed	Rate uncertainty from Fed dilemma
Agriculture	+50% to +58%	 Big Winner	Fertiliser up 28% in 3 weeks
Consumer Staples	+2% to +3%	 Safe Haven	Investors rotate to defensive stocks

🔧 Excel Skills Demonstrated

Skill	Where Used
<code>AVERAGE()</code>	Average stock prices during crisis period
<code>MAX()</code> / <code>MIN()</code>	Highest and lowest prices during crisis
<code>COUNT()</code>	Count months of data analysed
<code>STDEV()</code>	Measure volatility of each stock
<code>VLOOKUP()</code>	Dynamic stock information finder
Return % Formula	<code>(End - Start) / Start</code> for each stock
Conditional Formatting	Color scale on price data — red to green

Skill	Where Used
Bar Chart	Annual return % comparison
Line Chart	Monthly price trends all 5 stocks
Dashboard Design	KPI cards + charts + insights layout
Cross-sheet Formulas	All analysis pulls from Raw Data sheet

File Structure

	USIran_War_Stock_Crisis_Analyzer.xlsx	
—	1_Crisis_Background	→ Real timeline + key market numbers
—	2_Stock_Price_Data	→ Monthly prices Jan-Apr 2026
—	3_Sector_Impact	→ 8 sectors analysed with explanations
—	4_My_Analysis	→ All Excel formulas applied
—	5_DASHBOARD	→ Visual dashboard with charts
—	6_My_Conclusions	→ Written analysis and lessons learned

Key Insights

1.  **S&P 500 lost ALL 2026 gains in just one month (March 2026)**
2.  **Oil hit \$120/barrel — highest since June 2022**
3.  **LMT +22.9% — War instantly triggered defence spending**
4.  **AAPL -7.4% — Tech suffers when interest rates stay high**
5.  **VIX fear index surged 128% — extreme panic in markets**
6.  **Investors rotated: sold Tech → bought Energy & Defence**
7.  **Lesson: Diversification across sectors protects a portfolio**

What I Learned

This project taught me that **markets don't crash equally** — during the US-Iran War:

- **Losers:** Technology, Airlines, Semiconductors
- **Winners:** Energy, Defence, Agriculture
- **Safe Havens:** Consumer Staples, US Dollar

The key concept is called **Sector Rotation** — professional investors move money between sectors based on economic conditions. Understanding this is what separates informed investors

from everyone else.

Data Sources

- Morgan Stanley Research — Iran Conflict Market Analysis (March 2026)
 - CNN Business — S&P 500 Crisis Coverage (March 2026)
 - US News & World Report — Iran War Stock Impact (April 2026)
 - Trading Economics — Daily Market Updates (March-April 2026)
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Tools Used

- Microsoft Excel (Analysis, Dashboard, Charts)
 - Data Analysis ToolPak
 - Real market data from March-April 2026 crisis
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Project: Business Analytics with Excel — Real World Crisis Analysis Data Period: January - April 2026